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UNITED KINGDOM LIAISON MISSION IN JAPAN,
TOKYO.

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CONFIDENTIAL

119/1203/51

20th September, 1951.

FJ 10310/10

received in FED 10/10

Dear Charles,

As I said I proposed to do in my telegram No. 1286 of the 15th September, I spoke both to the United States Ambassador and to his deputy, Bond, about the possible dangers, from the point of view of the problem of the two Chinas, of allowing direct relations between the Japanese Government and the Chinese Mission here. FJ 1903/16

Bond did not think that there was much danger of this giving an opening to the Nationalists to put pressure on the Japanese Government to accord them recognition. He felt that Japanese business interests, with their eyes on future trade with mainland China, would be a sufficient brake on any precipitate action by the Japanese Government resulting from Nationalist manoeuvres. His own opinion was that the Japanese were determined to resume economic relations with mainland China within the measure compatible with their relations with the United States. I am inclined to share this view (and indeed it is quite consistent with what Yoshida has just told me - see my despatch No. 316 of 19th September) provided the United States Government abide by their agreement with us and allow the Japanese to make their decision when the time comes. If they were to intervene in any way, then my guess is that the present Government at any rate would do what they were told.

FJ 10511a

My conversation with Sebald was, I must confess, rather unsatisfactory. He seems, in fact, to be quite unaware of the agreement reached with Dulles which, after all, is one of the basic features of the Treaty. He told me, as he had done on a previous occasion, that he thought there might be difficulties regarding ratification if the Japanese were not at the time at least in negotiation with the Nationalists for a peace settlement. I told him that in my view such negotiations would be a breach, if not of the letter at any rate of the spirit, of what I understand to be our agreement.

I am really a little worried about Sebald and the China question. He is often curiously ill-informed, and, rather than indulge in suspicions that Dulles is not playing straight with us, I would like to suppose that he is speaking from ignorance. On the other hand, he has now very considerable influence in this country
and/

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and it would be very well if I or Dening when he arrives could put him straight authoritatively. I wonder therefore if there is any letter, message or even record of conversation which I could show him as evidence of the agreement with Dulles? (I cannot find anything suitable myself). Alternatively, Allison, who is, I understand, coming here on a brief visit in October, might possibly be persuaded to explain the position.

I am sending a copy of this letter to Tomlinson at Washington.

Yours ever

George Clutton

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